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WHEN AI ANSWERS FOR THEM: A TRANSLANGUAGING APPROACH TO RECLAIMING EFL LEARNERS' GRAMMAR COMPETENCE

Abstract – The proliferation of generative artificial intelligence tools such as ChatGPT and Gemini has created an unprecedented pedagogical challenge in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classrooms: students increasingly rely on these technologies to complete assignments without developing genuine grammatical competence. This classroom-based action research study investigates how a translanguaging pedagogical intervention contributes to transforming second-year Indonesian university students from passive AI reliance to active AI literacy in learning English grammar. Sixteen students initially completed a take-home grammar test with unexpectedly high scores, subsequently revealed through focus group discussion to have been achieved using ChatGPT and Gemini. A baseline in-class test confirmed low authentic competence, with only one student scoring above 70%. A five-week intervention combined explicit grammar instruction, targeted drilling, strategic integration of AI tools as learning scaffolds rather than answer generators, and a translanguaging approach in which the instructor used both Indonesian and English for explanation while encouraging students to draw on their full multilingual repertoires. Post-intervention results demonstrated meaningful improvement, with most students achieving 70% accuracy and only two scoring below 60%. The findings suggest that when AI tools are paired with translanguaging pedagogy and explicit instruction, students can develop both grammatical competence and critical digital literacy. This study contributes to the growing body of research on AI-integrated EFL pedagogy and offers practical implications for educators navigating the intersection of digital transformation and multilingual education in the Indonesian higher education context.

Keywords: translanguaging pedagogy, EFL grammar instruction, generative AI

INTRODUCTION

The proliferation of generative artificial intelligence tools such as ChatGPT and Gemini has created an unprecedented pedagogical challenge in English as a Foreign Language (EFL) classrooms. These tools, capable of producing human-like responses to a wide range of prompts, have become readily accessible to students worldwide, including those in Indonesian higher education contexts. While these technologies offer immense potential for supporting language learning (Chen et al., 2026; Torres & Kahveci, 2025), they also present a significant risk: students may use them to complete assignments without developing genuine linguistic competence. This phenomenon raises fundamental questions about the nature of literacy, assessment, and pedagogy in the age of artificial intelligence.

In the Indonesian EFL context, where English is taught as a compulsory subject from primary

through tertiary education, the challenge of ensuring authentic learning outcomes has long been a concern for educators. Traditional approaches to grammar instruction have often emphasized rote memorization and decontextualized exercises, leaving students ill-equipped to apply grammatical knowledge in communicative contexts. The emergence of AI tools has exacerbated this problem, as students can now bypass the learning process entirely by outsourcing their homework to generative AI systems. This practice, while efficient for task completion, undermines the development of grammatical competence and critical thinking skills that are essential for meaningful language use.

The concept of translanguaging offers a promising pedagogical framework for addressing this challenge. Originally emerging from Welsh bilingual education, translanguaging has been defined as the act of multilinguals selecting and deploying particular

features from their integrated linguistic repertoires to make meaning and negotiate particular communicative contexts (Vogel & García, 2017). Unlike code-switching, which treats languages as separate systems, translanguaging views multilingual practices as emerging from a single, unified linguistic repertoire (Cenoz & Gorter, 2022; Sohn et al., 2022; Wei, 2018). This perspective has significant implications for language pedagogy, as it legitimizes learners' full linguistic resources as tools for learning rather than obstacles to be overcome.

Recent research has demonstrated that translanguaging can serve as a catalyst for language acquisition by enabling learners to access more linguistic resources while engaging in syntactically complex collaborative conversations, thereby promoting second language (L2) output's quantity and quality (García & Wei, 2013; Li & Qu, 2024; Tai, 2024). Prior work has also shown that translanguaging fosters learners' morphological awareness and semantic understanding by treating L1 or heritage language as a genuine cognitive resource (Cenoz & Gorter, 2022). However, the mechanism by which translanguaging shifts learners from accessing lexical meaning toward engaging with syntactic structure remains underspecified.

Shan and Qi (2026) addressed this gap by investigating how translanguaging facilitates syntactic processing in an introductory L2 Chinese classroom. Their study revealed that translanguaging behaviors were frequently observed during communicative tasks, with different types of translanguaging serving distinct functions: L1-dominant intra-sentential translanguaging supported metalinguistic reflection on target structures, while L2-dominant intra-sentential translanguaging enabled learners to assemble new utterances through real-time syntactic processing. Importantly, their findings linked translanguaging to higher-order processing in L2 learning, demonstrating that translanguaging can support learners to disassemble L2 chunks into smaller linguistic items and repackage these items into new constructions through meaning-making.

These findings are particularly relevant to the Indonesian EFL context, where students navigate complex multilingual repertoires that may include Indonesian, regional languages (such as Javanese and Lampungnese), and English. Despite the linguistic diversity of Indonesian students, the majority of EFL classrooms have traditionally operated under monolingual ideologies that limit L1 use and enforce English-only policies (Masruria & Annisa, 2026; Zein, 2020). This creates a fundamental mismatch between standardized pedagogy and the linguistic realities of multilingual learners (Otheguy et al., 2015). Research in the Indonesian context has shown that translanguaging is a common and effective practice in EFL classrooms, serving to clarify grammar, build rapport, and support comprehension (Liando et al., 2023; Madkur et al., 2022; Titania & Ashadi, 2024). However, limited empirical research has examined how translanguaging can be intentionally integrated with AI tools to address specific pedagogical challenges.

The present study addresses the convergence of two contemporary challenges in Indonesian EFL education: the widespread use of generative AI by students to complete assignments, and the pedagogical potential of translanguaging to support authentic language learning. Specifically, this classroom-based action research investigates a pedagogical intervention designed to transform second-year Indonesian university students from passive AI reliance to active AI literacy in learning English grammar, particularly subject-verb agreement, which poses persistent difficulties for Indonesian learners due to structural differences between the two languages.

Drawing on the theoretical framework of translanguaging as a cognitive and pedagogical resource, and informed by the Output Hypothesis (Swain, 1985, 1995), which posits that language production pushes learners to notice gaps in their interlanguage and engage in syntactic processing, this study addresses the following research questions:

RQ1: How do second-year Indonesian EFL students navigate the use of generative AI tools in completing grammar assignments, and what does this reveal about their learning practices?

RQ2: What is the impact of a translanguaging-informed pedagogical intervention on students' subject-verb agreement competence?

RQ3: How do students perceive the integration of translanguaging practices and AI tools in their grammar learning?

METHODS

² Research Design

This study employed a classroom-based action research design, which is particularly suited for investigating pedagogical interventions in authentic educational contexts (Kemmis et al., 2014). Action research involves a cyclical process of planning, acting, observing, and reflecting, allowing researchers to systematically examine and refine educational practices. The design was appropriate for this study because it enabled the researcher to implement a targeted intervention in response to a specific classroom problem – students' over-reliance on generative AI tools for completing grammar assignments – and to evaluate its effectiveness through multiple data sources.

The study followed a primarily qualitative approach, with quantitative data used descriptively to support the qualitative findings. This integration of methods allowed for both the documentation of learning outcomes and the exploration of the processes through which those outcomes were achieved (Creswell & Clark, 2018). The qualitative emphasis was chosen because the study aimed to understand the *how* and *why* of students' AI use and their responses to the intervention, rather than to establish statistical generalizability.

² Participants

The participants were 16 second-year undergraduate students enrolled in a compulsory EFL course at a public university in the province of Lampung, Indonesia. The course, Complex Grammar, is one of the core subjects in the English Education program, designed to develop students' understanding and application of English grammatical structures. All participants were Indonesian native speakers, with Indonesian (Bahasa Indonesia) as the national and educational

languages. Additionally, most participants spoke Javanese or other regional languages as part of their multilingual repertoires, reflecting the linguistic diversity typical of Indonesian higher education contexts. The participants ranged in age from 19 to 21 years old ($M = 20.1$), and comprised 11 female and 5 male students.

The first author was also the course instructor, a position that offered both advantages and potential challenges. As the instructor, the researcher had intimate knowledge of the students' learning histories, established rapport with the participants, and could implement the intervention seamlessly within the existing curriculum. However, this dual role also required careful attention to ethical considerations, particularly regarding the voluntary nature of participation and the potential for students to feel pressured to respond in ways they perceived as desirable. To mitigate these concerns, students were assured that their participation was voluntary, that their responses would be anonymized in any research outputs, and that their grades would not be affected by their participation or non-participation. Informed consent was obtained from all participants prior to data collection.

The Learning Context

The study was conducted in the odd semester of the 2025/2026 academic year in the Complex Grammar course, a compulsory subject for second-year English Education students. The course aims to develop students' understanding and application of English grammatical structures, with a particular focus on areas of difficulty for Indonesian learners, including subject-verb agreement, the tense-aspect system, article use, and conditional structures. The course met once a week for 100 minutes per session. The regular instructional approach included a combination of explicit grammar explanation, contextualized practice, and communicative activities.

Procedures

The study was conducted over eight weeks and comprised five phases. Table 1 provides an overview of the timeline and data collected at each phase.

Table 1. Overview of study phases

Phase	Week	Activity	Data Collected
Phase 1	Week 1	Initial homework (10 TOEFL-like questions)	Homework scores
Phase 2	Week 2	FGD 1; Diagnostic in-class test	FGD transcript; Test scores
Phase 3	Weeks 3-7	Five-week intervention	Observations
Phase 4	Week 4	Post-intervention test	Post-test scores
Phase 5	Week 5	FGD 2	FGD transcript

In Phase 1, students completed ten TOEFL-like questions as homework and were permitted to use any resources. Upon collecting the homework in Phase 2, the instructor observed unexpectedly high scores and conducted a 45-minute focus group discussion (FGD) to investigate students' completion strategies. Students then completed a supervised in-class diagnostic test of comparable difficulty without access to external resources.

Phase 3 comprised a five-week pedagogical intervention implemented across five sessions (one session per week, 120 minutes each). The intervention consisted of three interconnected components. First, explicit grammar instruction followed a guided discovery approach (Ellis, 2006), covering basic subject-verb agreement (SVA) rules in Week 1, complex patterns in Weeks 2-3, and consolidation in Weeks 4-5. Second, guided practice with AI integration allowed students to use ChatGPT and Gemini as learning scaffolds rather than answer generators. Students followed a structured protocol: independent attempt, AI verification, explanation analysis, additional exploration, and peer discussion. Third, translanguaging pedagogy was employed throughout the intervention. The instructor used both Indonesian and English for metalinguistic explanations, and students were allowed to use their full multilingual repertoires—including

Indonesian, Javanese, and other regional languages—during discussions and peer interactions (García, Johnson, & Seltzer, 2017; Li, 2018).

In Phase 4, students completed a supervised post-intervention test of comparable difficulty to the diagnostic test. Finally, in Phase 5, a 50-minute follow-up FGD was conducted one week later to elicit students' perceptions of the intervention.

Data Collection

Grammar Tests

Three parallel forms of the grammar test were used, each containing ten TOEFL-like items. The items were selected from standardized TOEFL preparation materials (ETS, 2019; Phillips, 2018). The three forms were: (1) Initial Homework, (2) Diagnostic In-Class Test, and (3) Post-Intervention Test. Each test comprised a variety of patterns, including:

- Singular subject with present tense verb (e.g., The student ____ the assignment. → writes)
- Plural subject with present tense verb (e.g., The students ____ the assignment. → write)
- Indefinite pronouns (e.g., Everyone ____ invited. → is)
- Subjects with intervening phrases (e.g., The teacher, along with the students, ____ present. → is)
- Inverted sentences (e.g., There ____ many reasons for this. → are)
- Quantifiers (e.g., A number of students ____ late. → are; The number of students ____ small. → is)

Each test was scored as the percentage of correct answers (0-100%). Students' scores were recorded anonymously using participant codes, namely S1, S2, ..., S16.

Focus Group Discussions

Two focus group discussions were conducted: one following the initial homework assignment (Phase 2) and one following the intervention (Phase 5). The FGDs were semi-structured, using guiding questions to probe students' experiences, strategies, and perceptions. The guiding questions are provided in Appendix A.

Both FGDs were conducted in a mix of Indonesian and English, allowing students to express themselves in the language(s) they found most comfortable. This choice was consistent with the study's translanguaging approach and was intended to elicit richer, more authentic responses.

Classroom Observations

Throughout the intervention, the researcher maintained observational notes documenting student engagement, participation patterns, and interactions with AI tools. The observational notes included:

- Students' participation in translanguaging activities
- Students' engagement with AI tools during guided practice
- Instances of peer collaboration and discussion
- Students' questions and points of confusion
- Overall classroom atmosphere and student attitudes

These notes provided contextual information for interpreting the quantitative results and qualitative responses.

2 Data Analysis

Quantitative data from grammar tests were analyzed using descriptive statistics (means, ranges, frequency distributions). Qualitative data from FGDs and observations were analyzed using thematic analysis (Braun & Clarke, 2022), following the six-phase process: familiarization, generating initial codes, searching for themes, reviewing themes, defining and naming themes, and producing the report. Coding was conducted primarily in Indonesian to preserve nuance, with English translations developed for reporting. Member checking was conducted to ensure trustworthiness.

Ethical Considerations

Ethical approval was obtained from the university's research ethics committee. All participants provided informed consent and were assured of anonymity, the voluntary nature of participation, and the right to withdraw without penalty.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This section presents the findings of the study and discusses them in light of the three research questions. The results are presented thematically, integrating quantitative data from the grammar tests with qualitative data from the focus group discussions and classroom observations.

The AI Illusion: Uncovering Students' Reliance on Generative AI

The initial homework assignment, consisting of ten TOEFL-like questions, yielded unexpectedly high scores that were inconsistent with students' previous performance in the course. Table 2 presents the score distribution.

Table 2. Initial homework scores (AI-assisted)

Score (%)	Number of Students	Percentage
100	12	75.0%
90	1	6.25%
80	2	12.5%
70	1	6.25%
Mean	96.9	

These results were striking because they represented a dramatic improvement from earlier assessments, where students had typically scored between 50% and 80%. The homework scores suggested a level of mastery that seemed implausible given the students' demonstrated abilities in previous classroom activities.

During the Focus Group Discussion, all 16 students admitted to using generative AI tools—specifically ChatGPT and Gemini—to complete the homework. The analysis of the FGD transcript revealed several themes that illuminate students' AI use practices.

Theme 1: AI as a Convenient Solution to Perceived Difficulty

Students consistently described the homework as challenging and turned to AI tools as a quick and efficient solution. Several students noted that they did not attempt the questions independently before consulting AI.

"To be honest, I didn't try first. I just copied the questions into ChatGPT and used the answers. The questions were difficult, and I didn't want to get them wrong." (S3, FGD1)

"I opened Gemini and typed all the questions. It gave the answers in seconds. I didn't really think about whether I should do it myself because everyone else was doing it too." (S8, FGD1)

This theme reveals that students perceived the homework primarily as a task to be completed rather than as an opportunity for learning. The use of AI tools was framed as a pragmatic choice driven by time pressure, perceived difficulty, and a desire to avoid incorrect answers. This finding aligns with research by Cotton et al., (2024) and Sullivan et al., (2023), who documented similar patterns of AI use among students seeking to complete assignments efficiently without engaging in the cognitive processes that promote learning.

Theme 2: Lack of Awareness of Pedagogical Purpose

Several students expressed uncertainty about the purpose of homework and whether it was acceptable to use AI tools. This uncertainty stemmed in part from the absence of clear institutional guidelines regarding generative AI use.

"I wasn't sure if it was allowed or not. The lecturer didn't say we couldn't use ChatGPT, so I thought it was okay. But now I realize maybe it wasn't." (S5, FGD1)

"I thought homework was just about getting the right answers. I didn't think about learning from it." (S11, FGD1)

This theme suggests that students lacked a clear understanding of the pedagogical purpose of homework and the importance of independent effort for developing grammatical competence. This finding echoes concerns raised by Warschauer and Xu, (2024) about the need for explicit instruction on AI literacy and the ethical use of AI tools in educational contexts.

Theme 3: Recognition of the Disconnect between Homework and Actual Ability

During the FGD, several students acknowledged that the homework scores did not reflect their actual understanding of SVA. This recognition was often accompanied by expressions of concern about the upcoming in-class test.

"I know I got 100 on the homework, but I actually don't understand subject-verb agreement very well. I just used ChatGPT." (S7, FGD1)

"I feel like I cheated myself because I didn't learn anything from doing the homework." (S12, FGD1)

This theme indicates that many students were aware of the disconnect between their homework performance and their actual competence, suggesting that the issue was not simply one of dishonesty but also one of missed learning opportunities. This finding aligns with the concept of the "AI illusion" proposed in this study: the use of generative AI tools creates a false impression of competence that does not reflect students' actual learning.

Following the FGD, students completed a diagnostic in-class test under supervised conditions without access to AI tools. The results confirmed the gap between homework scores and actual competence. Table 3 presents the score distribution, and Table 4 compares individual student scores across the homework and diagnostic test.

Table 3. Diagnostic in-class test scores

Score (%)	Number of Students	Percentage
70	1	6.25%
60	4	25.0%
50	6	37.5%
40	3	18.75%
30	1	6.25%
20	1	6.25%
Mean: 49.4		

Table 4. Individual student scores: Homework vs. Diagnostic Test

Student	Homework (AI-assisted)	Diagnostic Test (in-class)	Difference
S1	100	50	-50
S2	100	60	-40
S3	100	50	-50

S4	100	50	-50
S5	100	40	-60
S6	100	50	-50
S7	100	60	-40
S8	100	30	-70
S9	100	50	-50
S10	100	40	-60
S11	100	60	-40
S12	100	50	-50
S13	90	70	-20
S14	80	50	-30
S15	80	20	-60
S16	70	60	-10
Mean	96.9	49.4	-47.5

The mean score dropped from 96.9% on the AI-assisted homework to 49.4% on the in-class test—a decline of 47.5 percentage points. Only one student scored above 70% on the diagnostic test, compared to 13 students who had scored 80% or above on the homework. The smallest gap was 10 points (S16), while the largest was 70 points (S8).

This dramatic decline confirms that the homework scores were not a valid indicator of students' SVA competence. The "AI illusion" had created a false impression of mastery that did not reflect students' actual learning. This finding has significant implications for assessment practices in the era of generative AI. Traditional take-home assignments may no longer provide valid measures of student learning, underscoring the importance of in-class, supervised assessment and assessment designs that are resistant to AI circumvention (Kohnke et al., 2023; Warschauer & Xu, 2024).

The findings also echo concerns about 'algorithmic monolingualism' raised by scholars of translanguaging (García & Wei, 2014; Shan & Qi, 2026). Just as translanguaging scholars critique monolingual ideologies that restrict students' linguistic repertoires, the present study suggests that unregulated AI use can similarly restrict learning by bypassing the cognitive processes that promote language development. When students use AI to answer questions, they bypass the noticing, hypothesis testing, and syntactic processing that Swain (1985, 1995) identified as essential for language acquisition.

The Impact of Translanguaging-Informed Intervention on Grammar Competence

Following the three-week intervention, students completed a post-intervention test under supervised conditions without access to AI tools. Table 5 presents the score distribution.

Table 5. Post-intervention test scores

Score (%)	Number of Students	Percentage
80	1	6.25%
70	11	68.75%
60	3	18.75%
50	1	6.25%
Mean: 69.4		

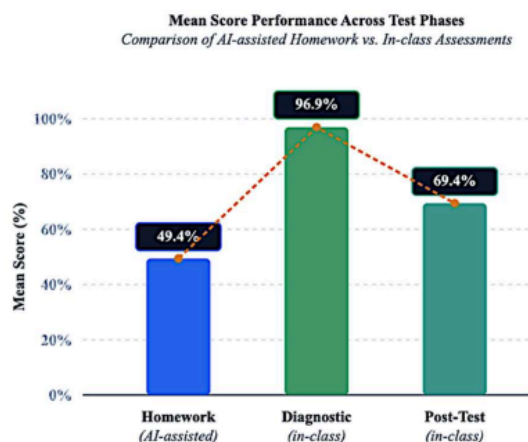
Table 5. Individual student scores across all test phases

Student	Homework (AI-assisted)	Diagnostic Test (in-class)	Post-Test (in-class)	Improvement
S1	100	50	70	+20
S2	100	60	70	+10
S3	100	50	70	+20
S4	100	50	70	+20
S5	100	40	70	+30
S6	100	50	70	+20
S7	100	60	70	+10
S8	100	30	60	+30
S9	100	50	70	+20
S10	100	40	70	+30
S11	100	60	80	+20
S12	100	50	70	+20
S13	90	70	70	0
S14	80	50	70	+20
S15	80	20	60	+40
S16	70	60	70	+10
Mean	96.9	49.4	69.4	+20.0

Note: S13 scored 70% on both the diagnostic test and post-test, as the student had demonstrated understanding of the grammar materials from the outset.

The mean score improved from 49.4% on the diagnostic test to 69.4% on the post-intervention test, representing a 20-point increase. All 16 students showed improvement, with gains ranging from 10 to 50 percentage points. The lowest post-test score was 50%, compared to a low of 20% on the diagnostic test. Figure 1 provides a visual summary of the score changes across the three test phases.

Figure 1. Mean scores across the three test phases



The figure shows a dramatic decline from the AI-assisted homework (96.9%) to the supervised in-class diagnostic test (49.4%), followed by meaningful improvement to the post-intervention test (69.4%). The 20-point increase from the diagnostic test to the post-test indicates the effectiveness of the pedagogical intervention.

While the post-test scores did not reach the artificially inflated levels of the AI-assisted homework, they represented a meaningful improvement in authentic competence. Notably, the distribution of scores became more clustered: 11 students achieved 70%, 3 students achieved 60%, and only 1 student scored below 60% (S15 at 50%). This contrasts with the diagnostic test, where scores ranged widely from 20% to 70%.

This improvement can be attributed to the three components of the intervention working in concert. First, the explicit grammar instruction provided students with the foundational knowledge they had previously lacked. Second, the guided AI use shifted students from passive reliance to active engagement with the learning material. Third, the translanguaging pedagogy supported deeper cognitive processing and reduced anxiety, enabling students to focus on understanding rather than on linguistic performance.

The finding that students improved when AI tools were used as learning scaffolds rather than answer generators is consistent with emerging research on AI literacy in education. (Lu et al., (2026) and Torres and Kahveci (2025) argued

that AI literacy involves not just technical skills but also critical thinking, ethical awareness, and the ability to evaluate AI-generated content. The present study suggests that these skills can be developed through explicit instruction and guided practice, even in a short intervention of three weeks.

Students' Perceptions of the Translanguaging-Informed AI Integration

The follow-up FGD conducted one week after the post-test revealed three major themes regarding students' perceptions of the intervention.

Theme 1: Changed Relationship with AI Tools

Students reported that their understanding of AI tools had shifted during the intervention. Whereas they had previously viewed AI primarily as a means to obtain correct answers quickly, they now saw it as a learning resource that could support their understanding when used strategically.

"Before, I just used ChatGPT to get the answers. Now I know I can use it to understand why the answer is correct. I ask it to explain, not just give the answer." (S6, FGD2)

"The most helpful thing was learning how to ask ChatGPT the right questions. If you ask 'what is the answer', you don't learn anything. But if you ask 'explain why this is correct,' you learn a lot." (S10, FGD2)

"I used to think ChatGPT was just for cheating. Now I see it can actually help me learn. But only if I use it the right way." (S2, FGD2)

This theme suggests that the intervention successfully promoted AI literacy—the ability to engage critically and productively with AI tools. Students recognized that the value of AI tools depends on *how* they are used, not simply on *whether* they are used. This shift from passive to active AI use is consistent with the Output Hypothesis (Swain, 1985, 1995). When students use AI tools to check their answers and analyze explanations, they are engaging in forms of output that may promote noticing, hypothesis testing, and syntactic processing.

Theme 2: Valuing Translanguaging for Learning

Students consistently expressed appreciation for the translanguaging approach, particularly the permission to use Indonesian and regional languages in the classroom. Many noted that being able to discuss grammar in their L1 reduced anxiety and improved comprehension.

"It was much easier to understand when the lecturer explained in Indonesian. I could focus on the rule instead of struggling with the language of explanation." (S9, FGD2)

"When we discussed in groups, we used Indonesian and sometimes Javanese. It was more comfortable and we could really talk about the grammar without worrying about making English mistakes." (S4, FGD2)

"I think I understood SVA better because we could explain it to each other in Indonesian. When you explain something in your own language, you really have to understand it." (S12, FGD2)

This theme aligns with research on translanguaging pedagogy (García & Wei, 2014; Wei, 2018) and with Shan and Qi's (2026) finding that L1-dominant translanguaging supports metalinguistic reflection. Students recognized that using their full linguistic repertoire enabled deeper cognitive processing and more effective peer collaboration.

In the Indonesian EFL context, where students navigate complex multilingual repertoires that may include Indonesian, Javanese, Sundanese, and other regional languages, the translanguaging approach served to legitimize students' linguistic identities and create a more inclusive classroom environment. This aligns with García & Lin's (2017) argument that translanguaging challenges institutional language hierarchies that marginalize certain languages and communities. Research in the Indonesian context has similarly documented the benefits of translanguaging, including improved comprehension, reduced anxiety, and enhanced participation (Liando et al., 2023; Miftakh et al., 2025; Titania & Ashadi, 2024).

Theme 3: Awareness of Learning and Metacognitive Growth

Several students reported increased awareness of their own learning processes, suggesting that the intervention fostered metacognitive growth. Students described noticing gaps in their knowledge and developing strategies to address those gaps.

"Before, I didn't really know what I didn't know. Now I can tell when I'm not sure about a rule, and I know how to check my understanding." (S5, FGD2)

"I realize now that the homework was supposed to help me learn, not just get a grade. I understand the material better because I actually did the work this time." (S11, FGD2)

"I used to just memorize rules without understanding them. Now I try to understand why the rule works. It's harder, but I learn more." (S14, FGD2)

This theme suggests that the intervention had an impact beyond improved grammar scores—it also promoted students' awareness of their own learning and their development of self-regulatory strategies. This finding aligns with Swain's (2006) concept of "languaging" as a cognitive tool for learning and with the broader educational goal of developing autonomous learners.

The Interplay of AI, Translanguaging, and Grammar Learning

The findings of this study reveal a complex interplay between AI use, translanguaging pedagogy, and grammar learning. The "AI illusion" created by unregulated AI use was addressed through an intervention that combined explicit instruction, guided AI use, and translanguaging pedagogy. The success of this intervention suggests that the integration of AI tools and translanguaging can be mutually reinforcing when implemented strategically.

The translanguaging approach in this study was not simply about allowing L1 use; it was a strategic pedagogical choice designed to support specific learning objectives. The instructor used Indonesian for metalinguistic

explanations and encouraged students to use their full linguistic repertoires for peer discussions and reflection. This strategic approach, informed by the theoretical framework of translanguageing, likely contributed to the intervention's effectiveness. This finding highlights the importance of intentional, theory-informed translanguageing pedagogy, rather than ad hoc or unreflective L1 use.

The theoretical contribution of this study lies in its demonstration of how translanguageing can support the “unpacking” and “packing” processes described by Ellis (2008) as central to syntactic development. When students used translanguageing to analyze SVA rules, explain these rules to peers, and check their understanding, they were engaging in the cognitive processes that promote language acquisition. This finding extends Shan and Qi's (2026) work on translanguageing and syntactic processing to the specific domain of EFL grammar instruction.

The intervention also addressed the concerns about academic integrity raised by the initial AI over-reliance. Rather than simply prohibiting AI use, the intervention provided students with the skills and awareness to use AI tools ethically and productively. This approach recognizes that AI tools are likely to become increasingly integrated into academic and professional contexts, and that the goal of education should be to prepare students for this reality (Kohnke et al., 2023; Sullivan et al., 2023).

CONCLUSION

This classroom-based action research investigated the convergence of two contemporary challenges in Indonesian EFL education: the widespread use of generative AI by students to complete assignments, and the pedagogical potential of translanguageing to support authentic language learning. A three-week translanguageing-informed intervention, combining explicit grammar instruction, guided AI use for learning rather than task completion, and translanguageing pedagogy, resulted in meaningful improvement in students' grammar competence. Students reported that the intervention shifted their relationship with AI

tools from passive reliance to active, critical use. They valued the translanguageing approach for reducing anxiety and enhancing comprehension, and they demonstrated increased metacognitive awareness of their own learning processes.

These findings have several implications for EFL pedagogy in Indonesia and similar multilingual contexts. First, educators must recognize that traditional take-home assignments may no longer provide valid measures of student learning in the era of generative AI, necessitating a rethinking of assessment practices. Second, students need explicit instruction on AI literacy, i.e., the ability to engage critically and productively with AI tools. Third, translanguageing should be recognized as a legitimate and valuable pedagogical approach that supports cognitive processing and creates inclusive learning environments. Fourth, AI tools can be integrated strategically as cognitive scaffolds that support learning rather than substitutes for thinking.

However, this study has limitations. The small sample size and the specific institutional context limit the generalizability of the findings. Future research could investigate whether similar patterns emerge in larger samples, different educational contexts, and with different target structures. The study did not include a delayed post-test to assess long-term retention of the learning gains. Future research could investigate longer-term interventions and the cumulative effects of repeated, integrated AI and translanguageing pedagogy. Finally, future research could explore the multimodal dimensions of translanguageing, such as gesture, gaze, and other semiotic resources, which were not systematically examined in this study.

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Appendix A: Focus Group Discussion Guiding Questions

Focus Group Discussion 1 (Following Initial Homework)

1. Bagaimana kalian mengerjakan PR grammar minggu lalu? [How did you complete the grammar homework last week?]
2. Apakah kalian menggunakan alat bantu apapun? Jika iya, apa dan bagaimana? [Did you use any resources? If yes, what and how?]
3. Mengapa kalian memilih untuk menggunakan alat tersebut? [Why did you choose to use those resources?]
4. Bagaimana perasaan kalian tentang PR tersebut? Mudah atau sulit? [How did you feel about the homework? Easy or difficult?]
5. Menurut kalian, apa tujuan dari pemberian PR grammar? [What do you think is the purpose of giving grammar homework?]

Focus Group Discussion 2 (Following the Intervention)

1. Bagaimana pengalaman kalian selama 5 minggu terakhir dalam pembelajaran grammar? [How was your experience during the last five weeks in grammar learning?]
2. Menurut kalian, apakah penggunaan ChatGPT/Gemini di kelas membantu atau justru mengganggu? [In your opinion, did using ChatGPT/Gemini in class help or hinder?]
3. Bagaimana perasaan kalian ketika boleh menggunakan bahasa Indonesia dan bahasa daerah di kelas? [How did you feel when you were allowed to use Indonesian and regional languages in class?]
4. Apakah cara belajar kalian berubah setelah mengikuti intervensi ini? [Did your learning approach change after this intervention?]
5. Saran apa yang kalian berikan untuk pembelajaran grammar di masa depan? [What suggestions do you have for future grammar learning?]

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